

PRIOR AUTHORIZATION CLINICAL SUBMISSION

Request / Insurance Information

PA Request ID	PA-2026-SC04
Submission Date	12-Aug-2026
Insurance/Payer	Aetna
Policy Type	Clinical Policy Bulletin (CPB)
Policy ID	CPB 0660
Policy Title	Knee Arthroplasty
Member ID	AET-SC04-1003
Policy Review Date	Last Review 02/26/2026; Next Review 07/23/2026
Coverage Order	Primary

Clinical/Orthopedic note

Patient	Michael Carter, 68-year-old male
Diagnosis	Primary osteoarthritis of right knee (M17.11)
Knee affected	Right knee
Pain severity	8/10
Functional limitation / ADL impact	Pain limits walking, stairs, prolonged standing, and other activities of daily living.
Physical examination	Tenderness, crepitus, mild effusion, and pain with weight-bearing.
Range of motion	Flexion approximately 95°; extension deficit approximately 5°.
Crepitus / effusion	Moderate crepitus with mild effusion.
Diagnosis history	Progressive osteoarthritis documented for approximately 3 years.
Treatment history	Orthopedic note states 12 weeks of supervised PT; referral summary states 8 weeks completed. The record does not reconcile the difference.
Physician recommendation	Right total knee arthroplasty recommended because of persistent pain and functional disability.

Conservative treatment record

Physical therapy	Supervised in-person physical therapy
Duration	8 weeks documented in therapy summary; orthopedic note states 12 weeks
NSAIDs / analgesics	NSAIDs/acetaminophen used
Exercise	Flexibility and muscle-strengthening exercises
Activity modification	High-impact activity reduced
Injections	One therapeutic knee injection >12 weeks before planned surgery
Assistive device	Cane used
Response to treatment	Persistent symptoms despite treatment

Imaging report

Imaging type	Standing AP/lateral/weight-bearing knee radiographs
Date	28-Jul-2026
Knee	Right
Radiographic findings	Joint-space narrowing, osteophytes, and subchondral sclerosis.
Severity of osteoarthritis	Moderate-to-severe; Kellgren-Lawrence Grade 3–4.
Other relevant findings	No acute fracture or dislocation.

Supporting documents

HbA1c	7.2% in laboratory report; 8.1% in a pre-operative summary dated 18-Jul-2026
Comorbidities	Type 2 diabetes and hypertension, clinically managed.
Previous surgery	No previous right-knee osteotomy or arthroplasty.
Previous knee replacement	None.
Contraindications	No active infection, open wound, recent corticosteroid injection, or documented implant allergy.